



THAIS

A BUDDHIST CULTURE

THE ETHNIC THAI PEOPLE ARE MADE UP OF FOUR core groups: Central Thai, Thai-Lao, Northern Thai, and Southern Thai. The 62 million Thais all descend from the natives of the Yunnan province in China and

City life

The streets of the capital city, Bangkok, are filled with traffic, from cars, bikes, and taxis, to the traditional three-wheeled vans known as *tuk-tuk*.

THAI SILK

Thailand is rich in crafts but perhaps the most famous is Thai silk, which is dyed to produce rich colors.



BUDDHISM

About 95 percent of Thais are Buddhists. They do not visit the temples regularly, but more often worship in their own homes at a shrine in front of a Buddha image. When believers are in a temple, tradition dictates that the head is lower than the Buddha image, or any Buddhist monks present, so they sit on the floor.



FLOATING MARKET

A number of narrow canals run through Bangkok. These are filled with narrow boats selling anything from food and drink to souvenirs. Almost all of the boats are paddled by women wearing blue with flat hats called *muak ngob*. The floating markets are still important commercial centers for those living along the banks.

